HTTPie cheat sheet

httpie/cli@3.2.4 (5b604c3) · 2026-11-02

If you only read one thing: in scripts and CI add `--ignore-stdin` (`-I`); otherwise HTTPie reads the body from stdin and `key=value` items exit 1.

Legend: ★ most used · ⚠ gotcha

START

```
pip install httpie
http pie.dev/get
http pie.dev/post a=1
http :8000/api
https example.org
```

`:8000` means localhost:8000. `https` defaults to `https://`. `--offline` ★ prints the request and sends nothing.

REQUEST ITEMS

Item	Sends
`X-Token:abc`	header
`X-Empty;`	empty header
`q==1`	query param
`name=Ada` ★	JSON string
`age:=36` ★	raw JSON value
`data=@f.txt`	field from file
`doc@f.txt`	file upload (multipart)

Data present and no method → POST.

NESTED JSON

```
http pie.dev/post \
  'user[name]=Ada' 'tags[]=a'
```

→ `{"user": {"name": "Ada"}, "tags": ["a"]}`

BODY TYPE AND METHOD

Flag	Effect
(default)	JSON body
`-f`, `--form`	urlencoded form
`--multipart`	force multipart
`--raw TEXT`	body as given
`PUT url a=1`	explicit method

WHAT GETS PRINTED

Flag	Prints
`-v` ★	request + response
`-h`	response headers only
`-b`	response body only
`-p HBhb`	pick: H/B request, h/b response
`-q`	nothing

Piped output prints the body only.

AUTH, SESSIONS, TLS

Flag	Use
`-a user:pw`	Basic auth
`-A bearer -a TOKEN`	Bearer token
`--session=dev`	save cookies/headers/auth
`--verify=no`	skip TLS check

`--session-read-only=dev` loads a session without writing it.

DOWNLOADS AND SCRIPTS

Flag	Effect
`-d` / `-d -c`	download / resume
`-F`	follow redirects
`--timeout 5`	seconds
`--debug`	env + request kwargs
`-o out.json`	save output to file
`-S`	stream line by line

`--check-status` ★ makes 3xx/4xx/5xx exit 3/4/5. Other exits: 2 timeout, 6 too many redirects, 7 plugin error.

DEVELOP

```
make all
make test
make codestyle
pytest tests/f.py::test_x
```

`all` creates `./venv`, installs, tests. `codestyle` runs flake8, a CI gate. `HTTPIE_CONFIG_DIR=/tmp/x` isolates config.

PLUGINS

`httpie cli plugins` then `install X`, `list`, `upgrade X`, or `uninstall X`. Install runs pip into the plugins dir.

GOTCHAS

- ⚠ `-h` is `--headers`, not help: use `--help`.
- ⚠ `age=36` sends `"36"`, a string. Use `:=`.
- ⚠ 404 and 500 still exit 0 without `--check-status`.
- ⚠ `default_options` in `config.json` apply to every call, tests too.
- ⚠ `--session` rewrites the file each run, because new headers and auth get saved.
- ⚠ Man pages are generated: edit `cli/definition.py`, then `make man`.